

# **Seniors United Now**

The Voice of Seniors in Alberta

May 04, 2023

#37, 2016 Sherwood Dr.  
Sherwood Park, AB  
T8A 3X3  
Phone: 780-449-1816  
Toll Free 1-855-786-8669

President  
Wayne Sorenson

Vice-President  
Stan Poznanski

Treasurer  
William Holtz

Secretary  
Vacant

Director  
Gerald Northam

Director  
Robert Price

Director  
Carolyn Reed

Director  
Rita DeLongchamp-  
Osborne

Director  
Francis Burkett

Executive Director  
Linda Osborne

Membership Coordinator  
Deborah Wilson

Office Administrator  
Lynn Penner

The Honourable Danielle Smith, ECA  
Premier of Alberta

307 Legislature Building  
10800 - 97 Avenue  
Edmonton, Alberta T5K 2B6

Email: [premier@gov.ab.ca](mailto:premier@gov.ab.ca)

Subject: Alberta Seniors Continue to Pay Doctor Medical Fees

Alberta Seniors United Now (SUN) is a non-profit, non-partisan organization established in 2003 to enable all seniors in Alberta to contribute and truly participate in the well-being of the Province of Alberta.

On behalf of our SUN Board of Directors, we were very pleased to hear your recent media statement that Albertans will not have to pay out of pocket to visit their medical practitioner; they simply have to use their Alberta Personal Health Card.

Recently SUN has received numerous concerns from Alberta seniors that they have had to pay out of pocket to their medical practitioners for a medical cognitive test. This medical exam is required when renewing their drivers license when they reach a certain age. These concerns prompted SUN to initiate a survey of seniors, attached for your convenience, are the results. We would bring to your attention that there does not appear to be a standard schedule of fees that seniors have had to pay. The fees charged ranged from \$0.00 to \$200.00 per test.

We are requesting that the medical cognitive test costs be covered by Alberta Health, the same as other medical procedures and tests. This would be a positive step in assisting struggling Alberta seniors in managing their daily living expenses.

Thank you for letting us bring this very important seniors' issue to your attention and we are looking forward to receiving your reply as soon as possible.

Sincerely,

*Wayne Sorenson*

Wayne Sorenson, President

c.c The Honourable Rachel Notley, ECA Leader of the Official Opposition  
c.c The Honourable Jason Copping, ECA Minister of Health  
c.c The Honourable Jeremy Nixon, ECA Minister of Seniors, Community and Social Services



# DRIVERS MEDICAL FEES SURVEY

| TOTALS                                                                                                                                                                                          |        | 212 |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|-----|
| Hard copy                                                                                                                                                                                       | 17.45% | 37  |
| online                                                                                                                                                                                          | 82.55% | 175 |
| 1) When did you have your last medical for renewing your driver's licence?                                                                                                                      |        | 212 |
| 2023                                                                                                                                                                                            | 20.28% | 43  |
| 2022                                                                                                                                                                                            | 48.11% | 102 |
| 2021                                                                                                                                                                                            | 21.70% | 46  |
| 2020                                                                                                                                                                                            | 4.25%  | 9   |
| 2019                                                                                                                                                                                            | 5.19%  | 11  |
| 2018                                                                                                                                                                                            | 0.47%  | 1   |
| 2017                                                                                                                                                                                            | 0.00%  | 0   |
| 2) Were you told you would have to pay a fee, prior to your examination.                                                                                                                        |        | 212 |
| YES                                                                                                                                                                                             | 85.38% | 181 |
| NO                                                                                                                                                                                              | 14.62% | 31  |
| 3) What was your approx. cost of the exam?                                                                                                                                                      |        | 212 |
| \$0.00                                                                                                                                                                                          | 10.85% | 23  |
| under \$25                                                                                                                                                                                      | 0.00%  | 0   |
| under \$50                                                                                                                                                                                      | 4.25%  | 9   |
| under \$75                                                                                                                                                                                      | 14.15% | 30  |
| under \$100                                                                                                                                                                                     | 27.36% | 58  |
| under \$125                                                                                                                                                                                     | 12.74% | 27  |
| under \$150                                                                                                                                                                                     | 21.23% | 45  |
| under \$175                                                                                                                                                                                     | 6.60%  | 14  |
| \$200                                                                                                                                                                                           | 2.83%  | 6   |
| OVER \$200                                                                                                                                                                                      | 0.00%  | 0   |
| 4) Were you aware that Medical Practitioners may charge various fees for this service.                                                                                                          |        | 212 |
| YES                                                                                                                                                                                             | 66.98% | 142 |
| NO                                                                                                                                                                                              | 33.02% | 70  |
| 5) Your annual medical exam includes vision, hearing & blood pressure tests which are covered by Alberta Health. Do you think cognitive ability tests should also be covered by Alberta Health? |        | 212 |
| YES                                                                                                                                                                                             | 93.40% | 198 |
| NO                                                                                                                                                                                              | 6.60%  | 14  |
| 6) Are you a SUN member                                                                                                                                                                         |        | 212 |
| YES                                                                                                                                                                                             | 78.77% | 167 |
| NO                                                                                                                                                                                              | 21.23% | 45  |
| Surveys submitted                                                                                                                                                                               |        | 212 |



Survey results from February 09, 2023 - May 01, 2023